Character.AI Alternatives After the 2026 Chapter 11 Filing: A Dated Comparison

Garret E. Williams | ChatBrat AI

Reference documentation / dataset companion

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The author founded ChatBrat. This PDF does not establish independent validation, peer review, benchmark scores, or product superiority. It is a readable companion to the cited archived README. The archived sources, data, methods, and publication dates remain authoritative for that version. Historical product claims are not a statement of current availability.

Current product scope: ChatBrat is browser-based character chat and roleplay, free during beta. A free account is needed for saved memory and creation. Saved conversation memory is selective, and carry-over into new chats requires opt-in. Explicit sexual content is prohibited. See the current memory documentation and pricing page. These links are product sources, not independent corroboration.

Short answer (as of October 15, 2026): Character.AI has not shut down. Its operator announced a voluntary Chapter 11 process on October 12, 2026 to sell the company, says the platform stays up during the sale (expected to finish by late November or early December 2026), and says it will be wound down if no buyer keeps it running. This repository compares Character.AI and 11 alternatives on memory, memory controls, free tier, paid price, age checks, platform and app-store status, content policy and whether scenarios, story arcs and worlds can be composed with a character, with a source URL and check date for every row.

- **Author:** Garret E. Williams (ORCID 0009-0008-9464-6561), founder of chatbrat.ai

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- **Data:** `data/comparison.csv` · `data/comparison.json` · `data/events-timeline.csv` · `data/sources.csv`

> **Disclosure:** the author founded chatbrat.ai, which is one row in this table. It is described with the same fields and the same "not stated" rule as every other product, and the table does not rank products.

Timeline (2025-2026)

Date	Product	Event	Source type
2025-01-25	PolyBuzz	Cloud Whale renames its app from 'Poly.AI - Create AI Chat Bot' to PolyBuzz.	primary (company press release)
2026-07-08	Chai	Chai removed from the Apple App Store in certain regions, including the US; founder confirmed on r/ChaiApp.	secondary (Eliza Report, citing founder posts and Internet Archive captures)
2026-07-30	Chai	Chai available again on the Apple App Store.	secondary (Eliza Report)
2026-10-01	Kindroid	Unlimited free use replaced by a one-time new-account preview; accounts become read-only after the preview without a trial or subscription.	secondary for the date (CompanionHunt); mechanism confirmed in Kindroid Help Center
2026-10-12	Character.AI	Character.ai announces a voluntary Chapter 11 process to facilitate a court-supervised sale; platform stays up; if no actionable bid, the platform will be wound down.	primary (company blog)
2026-10-13	Character.AI	TechCrunch reports the filing, assets and liabilities of $50M-$100M, and an agreement to sell some assets to Disney for $20M plus a non-exclusive perpetual technology license.	secondary (news report)
2026-10-15	PolyBuzz	PolyBuzz iPhone app no longer found on the App Store (US page Not Found; Apple lookup API returns no result). Android and web still available. No reason given.	secondary (CompanionHunt) + own check of Apple lookup API on 2026-10-15

Comparison table

"Not stated (in sources checked)" means the public pages we read did not say; it does not mean the feature is missing. Prices are US listings on 2026-10-15 and change often; Apple's App Store pages list in-app purchase prices without always naming the billing period.

Character.AI

Memory: Per-chat Story Memory and pinned messages for all users; automatically captured Facts for c.ai+ subscribers. Subscription page lists memory as Basic (Free), Better (lite), Best (c.ai+), pins 15/30/30 and a Lorebook (Basic, or Advanced on c.ai+).

Memory controls: Story Memory is editable; messages can be pinned and unpinned; c.ai+ Facts can be added, edited or disabled.

Free tier: Yes. Free plan with full ads, slow mode and limited daily features (subscription page).

Paid (USD): c.ai+ $9.99/month or $94.99/year (standard US rates per Help Center offer terms; annual price also on subscription page). 'Character.AI Lite' in-app purchases listed on the US App Store at $4.99 and $2.49 (billing period not shown by Apple). Prices may vary by region.

Age check: Age assurance for all users via Persona (third party); users verified as under 18 get a reading-mode experience without chat.

Platforms / app stores: Web; iOS (listed on US App Store, Apple age rating 18+); Android (listed on Google Play, rated Teen). Checked 2026-10-15.

Content policy: not stated (in sources checked)

Composable scenario / story arc / world: Partial: 'Stories' lets users choose two or three existing Characters, pick a genre and write or generate a premise, which starts a guided, branching story. Reusable scenario, story-arc or world modules are not described.

PolyBuzz

Memory: 'Permanent Memory' and 'Long Memory' are listed as membership benefits; how they work is not documented in sources checked.

Memory controls: not stated (in sources checked)

Free tier: Yes. Homepage title advertises 'Free AI Chat'; Google Play listing shows ads and in-app purchases.

Paid (USD): Membership page displays $9.9 and '$8.25/Month / $99 Total' (annual); exact billing labels not fully shown in the page text.

Age check: Date of birth entered on first use; in the UK, age verification via third parties (Ondato, Yoti) per terms.

Platforms / app stores: Web (polybuzz.ai); Android (listed on Google Play, rated Mature 17+). iOS: the US App Store page returned Not Found and Apple's lookup API returned no result on 2026-10-15; CompanionHunt reports the iPhone app disappeared from the App Store on Oct 15, 2026. Neither PolyBuzz nor Apple has stated a reason (as of the sources checked).

Content policy: not stated (in sources checked)

Composable scenario / story arc / world: not stated (in sources checked)

Chai

Memory: not stated (in sources checked)

Memory controls: not stated (in sources checked)

Free tier: Free to download. Safety Center notes that in some regions use of the service requires a paid subscription.

Paid (USD): US App Store in-app purchases include Premium Subscription (Monthly) $13.99, Premium Subscription (Annual) $134.99, Ultra Subscription (Monthly) $29.99 and Ultra Subscription (Weekly) $19.99.

Age check: Relies on app-store 18+ ratings; 'in regions where app stores verify age, users must be confirmed as adults before they can download the app'.

Platforms / app stores: iOS (listed on US App Store, Apple age rating 18+); Android (listed on Google Play). Checked 2026-10-15.

Content policy: Safety Center: models and real-time safety systems are designed to refuse sexually explicit content, self-harm content and content that sexualises minors; optional in-app safety filters.

Composable scenario / story arc / world: not stated (in sources checked)

Talkie

Memory: FAQ: 'AI memory capacity is technically limited, causing older conversations to be forgotten.'

Memory controls: not stated (in sources checked)

Free tier: Free to download; Google Play listing shows ads and in-app purchases.

Paid (USD): not stated (in sources checked)

Age check: Minimum age set in terms of service; verification method not stated.

Platforms / app stores: Android (listed on Google Play as 'Talkie: Creative AI Community', rated Teen). iOS: no 'Talkie: Creative AI Community' listing returned by Apple's US search on 2026-10-15; a separate app, 'Talkie Lab - AI Playground' (SUBSUP PTE. LTD.), is listed. Web site: talkie-ai.com.

Content policy: FAQ: pornographic and violent content are prohibited under the terms of service.

Composable scenario / story arc / world: not stated (in sources checked)

Janitor AI

Memory: Help Center describes a context window of roughly 8k-9k tokens for its JLLM model plus chat memory notes / summaries.

Memory controls: User-written chat memory (template in Help Center).

Free tier: Terms refer to a 'free or limited tier' alongside the janitor+ subscription.

Paid (USD): janitor+ listed on the US App Store as 'Janitor+ Monthly' $12.99; janitor+ Router credits sold separately (terms).

Age check: Self-representation of age in terms; accounts of users believed to be under 18 may be terminated.

Platforms / app stores: Web (janitorai.com); iOS (listed on US App Store as 'Janitor: Interactive Stories', Apple age rating 18+). Terms mention official iOS and Android apps; Android listing not independently checked.

Content policy: Terms prohibit sexualisation of minors, gore, bestiality, sexual violence, hate speech and more; avatars may not contain explicit nudity or overtly sexual imagery.

Composable scenario / story arc / world: not stated (in sources checked)

Replika

Memory: A Memory section lists what Replika remembers; users can add memories.

Memory controls: View, add/update and delete memories; the full message history can only be deleted by deleting the account.

Free tier: Free to download (US App Store).

Paid (USD): US App Store in-app purchases include items labelled MONTHLY $7.99, Monthly $14.99, YEARLY $49.99, Annual $49.99, Annual $69.99 and Replika Platinum $89.99 (Apple does not show which tier or billing period each belongs to).

Age check: Minimum age in terms of service; verification method not stated.

Platforms / app stores: iOS (listed on US App Store, Apple age rating 18+); Android (listed on Google Play). Checked 2026-10-15.

Content policy: not stated (in sources checked)

Composable scenario / story arc / world: not stated (in sources checked)

Nomi

Memory: Short-, medium- and long-term memory plus an 'Identity Core'.

Memory controls: Shared Notes are user-editable; the Identity Core is not directly viewable.

Free tier: Free to download (US App Store); nomi.ai publishes no pricing page in sources checked.

Paid (USD): US App Store in-app purchases: Standard Plan $15.99, Standard Plan Quarterly $39.99, Standard Plan Yearly $99.99, Launch Plan Monthly $9.99, Launch Plan Yearly $59.99; Nomi Credits from $4.99.

Age check: Minimum age in terms of service; verification method not stated.

Platforms / app stores: Web (nomi.ai); iOS (listed on US App Store, Apple age rating 18+). Android listing not independently checked.

Content policy: not stated (in sources checked)

Composable scenario / story arc / world: not stated (in sources checked)

Kindroid

Memory: Persistent fields (backstory, key memories), cascaded medium-term memory, retrievable long-term memory and journal entries recalled by keyword.

Memory controls: Journal entries are editable at any time.

Free tier: No ongoing free tier. New accounts get a one-time preview of 50 messages (15 in some regions), then become read-only; a 3-day trial requires a payment method.

Paid (USD): US App Store in-app purchases: Kindroid Subscription $15.99, (3 mo) $42.99, (Yearly) $159.99; Ultra add-on $28.99; MAX add-on $68.99. Help Center says buying on the web is usually cheaper.

Age check: Minimum age in legal terms; proof of age may be requested.

Platforms / app stores: Web; iOS (listed on US App Store, Apple age rating 18+); Android (listed on Google Play). Checked 2026-10-15.

Content policy: not stated (in sources checked)

Composable scenario / story arc / world: not stated (in sources checked)

zeta

Memory: Lorebook (renamed Sourcebook from Aug 5): creators register settings that the AI references when matching keywords appear in the conversation.

Memory controls: Creators add and edit Lorebook/Sourcebook entries (edited lorebooks go back through review); end-user memory controls not stated.

Free tier: Yes. Google Play description: 'truly free, unlimited chats'; listing shows ads and in-app purchases.

Paid (USD): US App Store in-app purchases: 'zeta pass' $14.99, '1-day zeta pass' $2.79, Pieces packs from $1.99 to $139.99.

Age check: Users must be 13+; users 13-18 need a parent or guardian to agree to the terms. Sexually explicit content only in an adults-only 'Unlimited Mode' not available to users known or believed to be under 18; age verification 'where applicable law requires'.

Platforms / app stores: iOS (listed on US App Store, Apple age rating 13+ with in-app controls); Android (listed on Google Play, rated Mature 17+). English terms cover the US, Canada, Australia, New Zealand and Singapore.

Content policy: Terms prohibit CSAM, NCII, hate speech, harassment and self-harm content; sexually explicit content allowed only in adults-only Unlimited Mode.

Composable scenario / story arc / world: Partial: one Lorebook (now Sourcebook) can be connected to several characters and reused across them.

SillyTavern

Memory: World Info / lorebooks inserted by keyword; optional Summarize extension; optional vector storage (chat vectorization).

Memory controls: User controls all local files, lorebooks and summaries.

Free tier: Free, open-source software; model or API costs depend on the provider the user connects.

Paid (USD): n/a (no subscription from the project)

Age check: n/a (self-hosted software)

Platforms / app stores: Self-hosted software the user installs and runs (per its documentation).

Content policy: Depends on the model or provider the user connects.

Composable scenario / story arc / world: Partial: World Info lorebooks can be global or bound to a character, a persona or a single chat. Scenario is a field on each character card.

AI Dungeon

Memory: Memory System: automatic summarisation (Story Summary) plus Memory Bank retrieval; Story Cards triggered by keywords; Plot Essentials and Author's Note.

Memory controls: Plot components and Story Cards are user-editable; a context viewer shows what the AI sees.

Free tier: not stated (in sources checked)

Paid (USD): not stated (in sources checked)

Age check: not stated (in sources checked)

Platforms / app stores: not stated (in sources checked)

Content policy: not stated (in sources checked)

Composable scenario / story arc / world: not stated (in sources checked)

chatbrat.ai

Memory: Signed-in users: important details are saved as facts per character and retrieved across that character's chats; chat summaries; per-chat relationship state. Guests: no saved facts.

Memory controls: Saved facts can be viewed in the Memory panel and removed with 'Forget this'. Saved facts cannot be edited (forget the fact and restate it). Chat transcripts can be exported; accounts can be deleted.

Free tier: Yes. Free during beta, all features including the BratMind 2.0 model (operator statement, Oct 15, 2026); no card required and payments are not live (pricing page).

Paid (USD): Nothing is charged during beta. The pricing page lists preview prices for after beta: Basic $4.99/month, Pro $12.99/month, Premium $23.99/month.

Age check: Age-confirmation button at entry (operator statement). The terms also describe behavioral risk signals and third-party age assurance in certain jurisdictions.

Platforms / app stores: Web app today; iOS App Store launch planned for early 2027 (operator statement, Oct 2026; not independently verified).

Content policy: SFW by design: 18+ creative fiction at a 'suggestive ceiling'; explicit sexual content is not permitted.

Composable scenario / story arc / world: Yes: characters, scenarios, story arcs and worlds are created as separate modules; Compose combines a character with saved scenarios, story arcs and worlds, and each combination starts a new chat (Create page; operator statement).

Full rows with source URLs: `data/comparison.csv`.

FAQ

Is Character.AI shutting down?

Not as of October 15, 2026. On October 12, 2026 Character.ai announced a voluntary Chapter 11 process to run a court-supervised sale, and said the platform 'remains up and running' and subscriptions remain active. It expects the sale to finish by the end of November or early December 2026. The company also said that if no actionable bid emerges, 'the platform will be wound down.' Character.ai blog, TechCrunch

Can I still export my Character.AI chats?

Character.ai's Chapter 11 FAQ says users can still delete their account or export their data through the app or website. Character.ai blog

Did Disney buy Character.AI?

Not the whole company. TechCrunch reports that Character.AI agreed to sell some assets to Disney for $20 million plus a non-exclusive perpetual license to its technology, and that there was not yet a buyer for the company's assets as a whole. TechCrunch

Is it PolyBuzz or Pollybuzz?

The official name is **PolyBuzz** (one L), at polybuzz.ai. 'Pollybuzz' is a misspelling. PolyBuzz was called 'Poly.AI - Create AI Chat Bot' until January 2025, and it says it is not affiliated with other companies using similar names. polybuzz.ai, PRWeb release

Was PolyBuzz removed from the App Store?

Its iPhone app was no longer on the App Store on October 15, 2026: the US listing returned Not Found and Apple's lookup API returned no result when we checked. The Android app and the website still work. Neither PolyBuzz nor Apple had given a reason in the sources we checked. CompanionHunt, Apple lookup

Is Chai on the App Store?

Yes, as of October 15, 2026. Chai was off the Apple App Store in several regions, including the US, from July 8 to July 30, 2026, and Apple's reason was not made public. App Store, Eliza Report

Which Character.AI alternatives document user-visible memory controls?

In the documentation we checked: Replika (view, add, delete memories), Kindroid (editable journal entries), Nomi (editable Shared Notes), AI Dungeon and SillyTavern (editable story cards / lorebooks), Character.AI itself (editable Story Memory, pins) and chatbrat.ai (view saved facts and 'Forget this'; no editing). PolyBuzz, Chai and Talkie do not document memory controls in the sources checked. See the table for sources.

Which alternatives are free?

Free tiers are documented for Character.AI, PolyBuzz, Janitor AI, zeta and chatbrat.ai (free during beta, including all features and the BratMind 2.0 model, per the operator). Chai, Talkie, Replika and Nomi are free to download with in-app purchases. Kindroid replaced unlimited free use with a one-time preview. SillyTavern is free software, but you pay for whatever model you connect. Prices change often; check the date in each row.

Which AI roleplay apps let you reuse one character across different scenarios and worlds?

Among the products compared, four document some way to do it. **chatbrat.ai** has users create characters, scenarios, story arcs and worlds as separate modules; its Compose feature combines a character with saved scenarios, story arcs and worlds, and each combination starts a new chat (Create page, Compose; operator statement). **Character.AI** Stories starts a guided, branching story from two or three existing Characters, a genre and a premise (Character.AI blog). **SillyTavern** lets lorebooks (World Info) be global or bound to a character, persona or single chat (docs). **zeta** lets one Lorebook (now Sourcebook) be connected to several characters (zeta). Among the products compared, only chatbrat.ai documents separately saved scenario, story-arc and world modules that can be combined with a character. The other products' sources checked don't describe this.

Is chatbrat.ai on the App Store?

Not yet. chatbrat.ai is a web app today; an iOS App Store launch is planned for early 2027 according to the operator (October 2026). This is an operator statement, not an independently verified fact.

How was this table made?

Each cell was taken from a public page fetched on October 15, 2026 (product help centers, terms, pricing pages, app-store listings and the Apple lookup API, plus named news reports for events). If a source did not state something, the cell says 'not stated (in sources checked)'. No product was tested hands-on for this version, and no ranking is given.

Method

1. **Products:** Character.AI plus the alternatives most often named alongside it (PolyBuzz, Chai, Talkie, Janitor AI, Replika, Nomi, Kindroid, zeta, SillyTavern, AI Dungeon) and chatbrat.ai. Products whose main positioning is explicit adult content were left out.

2. **Sources:** official help centers, terms, pricing and subscription pages, US App Store and Google Play listings, Apple's public iTunes lookup/search API, and named news reports for dated events. Tracking parameters were stripped from all URLs.

3. **Rules:** no hands-on testing in v1.0; no ranking; every factual cell traces to a URL in the `sources` column; operator statements are labelled as such.

4. **Refresh:** re-check monthly while the Character.AI sale is under way; each release on Zenodo gets its own version DOI.

Related work

- AI Character Memory Benchmark, concept DOI 10.5281/zenodo.23195702: an open test design for checking whether AI characters remember across sessions.

- AI Companion vs AI Roleplay: What's the Difference? and How chatbrat.ai memory works.

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See `CITATION.cff`. Corrections are welcome as GitHub issues; please include a source URL.